

Mix It Up

First, you need to have a mix of long-term *and* short-term goals. The long-term goals are the ones with huge payoffs, like hitting the \$1 million net-worth mark or paying off your house. I love long-term goals, because those are the ones that really move the needle. Changing your life and your family's legacy doesn't happen overnight; that's the result of years and decades of focused intensity. So your biggest goals will be long-term, way off in the distance.

As important as these big goals are, though, you also need to regularly add in short-term goals. You can't expect to stay motivated throughout a twenty-, thirty-, or forty-year journey unless you're seeing wins all along the way. These wins come from short-term goals, such as saving up for a great vacation or buying a car with cash. Knocking out short-term goals gives you a sense of accomplishment and encouragement as you continue to attack your long-term goals. It lets you see that your plan is working, even if you don't have a \$1 million net worth yet.